I'll imagine we fell in love

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/64440073.

Rating:
Teen And Up Audiences

Archive Warning:
No Archive Warnings Apply

Category:
M/M

Fandom:
崩坏：星穹铁道 | Honkai: Star Rail (Video Game)

Relationship:
Mydei/Phainon (Honkai: Star Rail)

Characters:
Phainon (Honkai: Star Rail), Mydei (Honkai: Star Rail)

Additional Tags:
Alternate Universe - Modern Setting, Friends to Lovers, Idol Phainon, Rockstar Mydei, Love Confessions, Phainon is Down Bad (Honkai: Star Rail), Mydei is Down Bad (Honkai: Star Rail), they act like they are dating before even actually dating, Fluff, Idiots in Love, 5+1 Things, Getting Together, Mutual Pining, Fluff and Humor

Language:
English

Series:
Part 1 of backstage

Stats:
Published: 2025-04-05 Words: 6,359 Chapters: 1/1

I'll imagine we fell in love

by aurellya

Summary

Phainon loves music.

Lives and breathes it ever since he could remember, from when he had been but just another person posting cover videos online, to when Aglaea had scouted him one fine day when his friends had nudged him onto a bar's stage, and even now as his days are filled with countless appearances on camera and work phone buzzing with notifications.

Now, of all times, Phainon finds his mind blank as he stares at the words written on the post-it he had pasted on a corner of his notebook. A single, untouched sentence amidst countless illegible scribbles:

'Young Love - Falling in love with someone you've known for a long, long time. A first love, sweet and innocent.'

The first thing that comes to mind, unsurprisingly, is a fiery head of hair braided at one side. The tattoo beneath a golden eye, matching the lines trailing down a muscled chest and disappearing beneath fabric. The smile that quickly turns into a scowl as Mydei— Oh shit, Mydei—

— Where Phainon tries to write a song about love, and Mydei helps (by being the person Phainon happens to be in love with).

Notes

blue - yung kai <3

See the end of the work for more notes

- Translation into 中文-普通话 國語 available: 【授翻/厄敌】幕後花絮 by Kubicmay

“I’ll imagine we fell in love”

The night is far too quiet.

In the silence, each press of his pencil to paper accompanies a gentle tune hummed, fingers tapping as Phainon lets the song’s lyrics come to being—or at least that is what he tries to do for the umpteenth time that night before yet another piece of paper is crumpled and tossed off to the side in frustration.

Usually, writing songs comes much easier to Phainon. The words at his fingertips as he weaved them along the threads of the instrumental put together in the little moments of his day to form a story as written in his mind.

Come up with a theme, write songs based on it, pitch to his company and prepare the album. *Rinse and repeat.* That is how things usually go, easy enough especially with how his company usually allowed him to retain creative direction from concept to sound and choreography, and even stage design.

A rare grace in what is usually such a commercialised industry made to cater to the masses. (Though not even Phainon could escape the rigorous schedule of training, and fun as dance may be, he finds he still prefers the comfort and simplicity of just his voice, guitar, and minimal backtrack at times.)

Phainon loves music. Lives and breathes it as far as he can remember.

From when he had been but just another person posting cover videos online, to when Aglaea had scouted him one fine day when his friends had nudged him onto a bar’s stage, and even now as his days are filled with countless appearances on camera and his work phone buzzing with notifications. Within each song lies fragments of him—cheesy as that may sound—no

matter how involved Phainon himself had been in its creation. Each one a piece of his story, performative as some may be.

Yet now, of all times, Phainon finds his mind blank as he stares at the words written on the post-it he had pasted on a corner of his notebook. A single, untouched sentence amidst countless illegible scribbles:

‘Young Love - Falling in love with someone you’ve known for a long, long time. A first love, sweet and innocent.’

“First love, huh?” Phainon says quietly, letting the words drift into the silence. Offers it up as if the silence could reply.

It is not as if Phainon has not written anything about love. Quite the opposite, really. But somehow his mind seemed to be pulling blanks no matter how hard he thought of first love, so often described as exhilarating, consuming, like starting a fire— *you are captivated by it, wanting to lean into the warmth of it* —pure and simple, the whims of a young heart.

How do you write about such a thing without having known it for yourself? Running a hand through his hair, Phainon lets his pencil fall from his fingers as he leans back against his bed frame. He closes his eyes, thinking of *love . Love… love… love…*

The first thing that comes to mind, unsurprisingly, is a fiery head of hair braided on one side. The tattoo beneath a golden eye, matching the lines trailing down a muscled chest and disappearing beneath fabric. The smile that quickly turns into a scowl as Mydei— *Oh shit, Mydei—*

Scrambling for his phone that he belatedly remembers to have put on silent, Phainon curses as he sees the string of messages staring right back at him.

[Mydei: ?]

[Mydei: Where are you?]

[Mydei: … I’ll go wait by the cafe.]

The messages were sent thirty minutes ago. Right when Phainon was supposed to meet Mydei. At least, until he had gotten lost in thought… And so within two, Phainon is rushing out the door with little but a quick check to make sure he at least looks good enough not to worry Mydei, hand running through his hair to organise the strands the best he can.

At the quiet cafe down the street is where Phainon finds Mydei at an outdoor table, guitar in his lap as a small group of children sit around him with bright smiles on their face—all of whom turn to Phainon the moment Mydei's hand pauses on the strings, voice drifting off as he tilts his head at Phainon, shoulders relaxing ever so slightly at the sight of him.

For a moment— *really just a second, Phainon swears*— Phainon thinks Mydei looks beautiful like this, the soft, almost gentle expression on his usually serious face gently lit by the midday sun like a rare treasure he had been lucky to stumble upon. Just like the princes in those stories Castorice so liked to talk about, links after links sent his way each time he tried to ask around for inspiration.

Unsure of what else to do, Phainon waves back with the brightest smile he can find as he slides in to lean against the seat by Mydei's side, their shoulders bumping as he settles in place. Belatedly, Phainon realises he had completely forgotten the mask he usually wore outside… or even his sunglasses… but thankfully the children, at least, say nothing as they chatter among themselves.

"Having some fun all alone, are you Mydei~" Phainon leans in, brushing a strand of hair out of Mydei's face when the other looks up to face him, unreadable even as a slight scowl takes its place on those lips so close to his own as Mydei turns.

Grinning in response, Phainon turns back to the children gathered around and asks, "This handsome man is really good at playing the guitar and singing, isn't he?"

As expected of the great Mydeimos, a chorus of agreements comes in response.

“You’re late.” Clearing his throat, Mydei replies. Yet behind the fist held in front of his mouth, Phainon sees the barest hints of red dusting Mydei’s cheeks, notices the way Mydei averts his gaze just so. And it takes everything in him to not try and tease the other further lest he face a lion’s claws out in public—knowing as he does that Mydei would never do such a thing.

Adorable is hardly a word anyone else would dare call Mydei. The same man who shines like a blazing sun in the darkness the moment he takes the stage, a single spotlight and his guitar in hand all he needs to draw all around him in. Mydei does not need flashy radiance that one may so often think of first. *No.* Mydei enchants with a steady, quiet aura—a flowing river of fiery passion the moment the first note rings through the venue. A regal lion even as he tears his way across the stage.

But the Mydei that Phainon sees, hair pulled back with a red ribbon and a glass of pomegranate juice turned pink with added cheese foam before him alongside a small plate of pancakes at the centre of the table left ignored as he speaks to the children, tells them to return to their parents who watch not too far away before they worry and encourages them to chase their dreams with fervour… this too is Mydei himself. Genuine as ever, after all Mydei never really was good at acting (and this, too, Phainon could especially vouch for, the evidence of which he truly would face Mydei’s wrath for should he ever reveal them).

“Enjoy your date, misters!” One of the children grins back at them, all toothy smiles and overflowing energy as they skip away back to the waiting arms of their parents who laugh and signal back an apology.

A date, hm? Returning the smile, Phainon nods all too excitedly as he offers a thumbs up in return. “We will!”

Already, Phainon can feel Mydei’s gaze burning into him. And so, before the other can react, Phainon is quick to speak first—voice lower, calmer now as a hand moves to rub the back of his neck and a sheepish smile takes its very much deserved place on his lips. And it is then that Phainon realises the graphite stains left on his fingers, quickly taking a napkin to rub them away but only ending up smudging it even further.

“Sorry, haha, I got caught up in some work and seem to have forgotten the time. Forgive me, *Mydeimos* ?”

Mydei closes his eyes. Takes in a deep breath that is held for a second, and then two— and Phainon is all too ready to head to the counter and purchase another dessert for the man to hopefully make up for it before Mydei instead reaches out to flick his forehead.

“You had me worried, you idiot. Maybe next time I should visit your apartment itself.”

As if that had not been enough, Mydei reaches for Phainon’s hand, wiping at the darkened marks until they disappear before neatly folding the napkin and placing it back down on the table. *Oh.*

And Phainon swears that he had not been distracted by the way Mydei’s hands held his, fingertips roughened by guitar strings brushing against his skin ever so slightly, touch running ever so slightly warmer— No, not at all.

Who was he kidding?

“Well… I did give you the keys for a reason~” This is the truth just as much as it is Phainon’s attempt to poke back at Mydei, victory held in the way golden eyes roll at the clearly teasing comment.

So Mydei had been worried about him . The thought circles around Phainon’s mind, warms his heart, and Phainon barely stops himself from speaking any further. Instead, he reaches for the fork innocently resting upon porcelain, carving out a piece of the honey-coated pancakes before bringing it to his mouth. A burst of sweetness follows, but the look Mydei gives him is even sweeter as he reaches over—

Only to take the fork back and finish up the last bite of the pancakes.

“I'd rather not walk in on you half-naked.”

“Says the one who almost always performs shirtless on stage.”

Another exasperated sigh, and then Mydei is standing, drink in hand and guitar bag slung over his shoulder as he watches Phainon expectantly.

“Tch. It’s getting late, let’s go.”

Phainon blinks back at him in confusion, “Running away, Mydeimos?”

“We have a performance together at the library. In case you forgot, *you* were the one who said you wanted to come along.” And it is then that it finally clicks. As far as Phainon knows, Mydei did not have any shows for the day and yet he had his guitar with him. Then there was that strange feeling he had been forgetting *something*.

“Oh. Right.” Turns out that ‘something’ had been the session at the public library in the neighbourhood, with Mydei being a regular each week or so (as for how Phainon knows this, well—). One thing led to another, and Phainon had managed to convince the other, so here they were. “Well then, what are we waiting for?”

Without a second thought, Phainon jumps up from his seat and hooks an arm around Mydei’s, already tugging the other toward the library.

“Do you even remember what song you want to do?” As they pause at a crossing, Mydei asks, eyeing Phainon with suspicion.

Oh Mydeimos, Phainon shrugs, “How about the one from *that time* ?” To the man’s credit, the only thing giving away his surprise is the way he falters in his next step ever so slightly.

“We’ve never performed that one live, are you sure?”

The song in question, without a name to date, is one they had made over ten days spent clashing in the studio—the product of a competition between them to check the other out back when they had first met. Something that had become a part of ‘them’. And, for some reason, it felt just perfect for their first public appearance together.

Though maybe Aglaea would have a word to say once she hears about it.

“With you? Of course.”

For the second time that day, Mydei cracks a smile. That is enough to make Phainon’s day.

“I’ll nap under moonlit skies with you”

Mydei should smile more , Phainon thinks. Not just in the way he does on stage, all charisma and wild charm, but the one like the sun on a clear day, features softening… Just like the one he offers the children at the library each time, or the one Phainon gets to see oh so briefly before Mydei looks up from his phone to greet him (just *what is it that he was looking at which could have him smiling so…*), or the one now as Phainon holds out a box to Mydei under the cover of night.

Upon a gentle slope do they rest, unbothered by the grass crunching beneath them as they watch the glittering sky above. This late, the park is quiet as the city around it slumbers peacefully, speckles of building lights joined by the countless twinkling stars that light up the dark canvas. A beautiful sight. But one that could hardly compare to the man before him.

The cool breeze tousles Mydei’s hair, the strands caressing his cheeks, that signature braid of his spared the treatment as his smile beams on, and suddenly Phainon finds his mouth far too dry to speak as his hold on the box falters—almost dropping it before he steadies the precious thing in his hands once more.

“A gift, for the anniversary of us knowing each other. No strings attached, promise.” Phainon opens the box, revealing a chain of gold holding a blue pendant that gleams in the dim light. “It reminded me of you, kind of.”

An aimless stroll along his childhood street had brought him to the doors of an unassuming jewellery shop, within which were antiques and modern pieces all the same. Yet Phainon found himself drawn to a small section in a corner where a collection of gems lay across velvet kept within glass, but one word written on the label. *‘Kremnos’*, it read, painted in gold. And it

took all but a few minutes for Phainon to call over the storekeeper and put in his request, far too long spent choosing from the gold chains laid before him before finally settling on one, but the time was worth it in the end.

‘This used to belong to a King’, the storekeeper had told him, wrinkles at the corners of their eyes crinkling as they smiled, guiding Phainon in gently wiping across the gem’s surface, materials prepared to set it to be used as a pendant. *‘The final King, or so they say. Stories passed down of it being discovered beside a white lily coated in gold.’*

Whether they were telling the truth or not mattered little. Call him naive and foolish if you will, delusional even, but a part of Phainon believed the tale even before he heard it. And what better to give the king of the stage (and ruler of his heart, as a friend, of course) than such a gem. *Besides, Mydei would be able to make anything look good anyway.* This, Phainon is sure of, unfortunately not out of experience… yet.

“It’s blue,” Mydei states flatly, and Phainon can’t help but laugh at the look on his face—brows furrowed and lips in a flat line. And it is almost like the world has decided to tease him further, for, not too far away, a cat peeks out from under a bench, practically mirroring the expression Mydei gives him as it takes a step forward before rushing away at the sound of barking in the distance.

“Something different as a change wouldn’t be too bad, Mydeimos~ Besides, it’s like having a piece of me with you! Wouldn’t that be more fitting, heh. You’ll have something to remember me by.”

“Ridiculous.” Mydei huffs, signature scowl on those lips as he looks back up at Phainon. His hand reaches out, nudging the box back toward Phainon, before turning away once more and mumbling something under his breath.

Blinking back in confusion, Phainon leans in. “Hm?”

“The necklace won’t put on itself.” From this angle, the surrounding light hits the angles of Mydei’s face *just so* , but Phainon tears himself away from the sight to shuffle slightly behind Mydei who sweeps his hair aside, baring his neck to the cool night breeze.

“As you wish~” The necklace is brought around Mydei’s neck, Phainon’s fingers brushing against skin ever so slightly as he brings the ends together, breath puffing across the back of Mydei’s neck that reddens quickly.

And if Phainon lingers there for a moment longer than necessary after he sets the clasp in place, neither says anything.

“All done.” Clearing his throat, Phainon settles back down in the grass, takes in the view of Mydei beside him with the curtain of stars at his back, and pats the spot beside him.

“Like old times?” He asks, patting the space beside him. And, to his surprise, Mydei doesn’t take too long to join—both of them side by side without a care in the world.

A tune comes to Phainon’s mind then, light and drifting, like a promise just as much as it is the hope for one. Strolling in the sun just as much as it is seeking solace under the reflection of the moon. Near one moment, and far the next as they go from side by side in each other’s embrace to whispering thoughts into the distance. A silent yearning for that sun up above.

And, later, in the dim light of the studio, do his fingers bring this image to life once more.

[Mydei: Don’t stay up too late, you fool.]

[Mydei: … Thank you, I will keep it on me.]

[Phainon: I’m glad you like it!]

[Phainon: Also you don’t need to wear it all the time, it’s fine.]

[Phainon: Besides, your stylists will probably have a problem with it haha. What with all that red you always wear.]

[Phainon: Hmm… maybe you should try purple then.]

[Mydei: Absolutely not.]

The messages on his phone flit by, not a single one ignored even as Phainon's phone finds itself precariously balanced in his hand as the pencil he had been writing with held between smiling lips, elbow resting on the curve of his guitar and headphones pulled down even though Mydei's voice is nowhere to be heard.

A glance down at the purple of his pants (which Aglaea unfortunately had called horrendous and banished to the depths of his closet for use at home only alongside the golden yellow of the shirt he now wears), and Phainon vaguely remembers the time Mydei had stayed over as they had written the song, the pair the only other thing he could offer at the time.

Ok, maybe Mydei has a point…

And for whatever reason at all, Phainon's traitorous mind thinks further. Of reds and blacks replaced with blues and whites… gold trimming throughout… a shining star in the darkness. *Perhaps a colour palette swap wouldn't be too bad, though those tattoos might cause a problem.*

Only after Mydei doesn't reply any further does Phainon finally set his phone back down, guitar almost tumbling out of his lap as he leaned over to place it on the table.

"Good night, Mydeimos." Phainon sighs, almost forgetting the pencil until it tumbles from his lips before he can catch it, tucking it by his ear instead.

"I think I'll picture us, you with the waves. The ocean's colours on your face."

Lounging on the sofa in the dressing room, Phainon sighs as he sketches yet another image into his notebook where countless lines of what were supposed to have been lyrics lie scribbled about, hearts scattered across the page as if the very image of them could remind Phainon of what he was supposed to be writing about.

Love… love… love… Frustrated, Phainon almost considers ripping the page out and starting anew when something at the corner of the page catches his eye.

Right there, in the corner, lies an unmistakable figure glaring back at him, arms crossed over their chest and chin upturned, a speech bubble far too messy to read by its side save for the letters *‘H’, ‘K’,* and *‘S’* in the space beside it so clearly in a different handwriting from the rest of it all.

Huh, must have been from when I accidentally took a nap earlier, Phainon thinks as he rubs at a smudged line from when his pencil had probably skidded across the page the moment he had drifted off on complete accident the other day after they had taken a quick trip to the beachside in yet another one of Phainon’s attempts to gain inspiration.

Unfortunately, his notes remain completely blank save for sketches of Mydei as they walked along the water’s edge, footprints left in the sand soon swept away by the coming and going of the waves that lapped at the shoreline. Though Phainon finds that he cannot quite complain at all as he flips through the pages and sees sketch after sketch. Mydei waiting for him, Mydei with a flower in his hair, Mydei—

Instrumental pierces through the air that very moment, like a sharp blade breaking through the fabric of the world, and all thoughts disappear as Phainon turns his head to the monitor.

Even through a screen, Mydei is *mesmerising* . All rogue charm as he commands the stage, the thin sheen of sweat across his skin only further highlighting the definition of his muscles as his fingers work across the strings of his guitar… run through his hair… holds the microphone so—

It is then that Phainon notices.

A blue gem sparkles under the stage lights, standing out starkly against the flaming tattoos painted across Mydei’s skin, white fabric flowing behind him in place of the usual black. Rub at his eyes he might, but the sight of Mydei in such colours remains oh so very real before him.

The necklace Phainon had given him not too long ago sits right there on his chest, catching the light as Mydei crosses the stage, burning along with him before the crowd whose phones flash wildly and screams only grow higher with each song performed.

The familiar sound of a notification popping up on his phone tears Phainon's attention away—loath as he is to do so—the deep bass reverberating over from the main stage a constant buzz as he finally looks down at his phone. And one look at the name has Phainon immediately opening the messaging app:

[Aglaea: I suppose you are with Mydeimos as usual, Phainon.]

[Phainon: Ah, nothing can escape your eyes~]

[Phainon: What's up?]

[Aglaea: About the upcoming project—]

Aglaea is typing…

Before Aglaea's next message can appear, the door to the dressing room creaks open. And it is only then that Phainon realises the screen has gone dark, and the beat that had rung throughout the building has now gone silent.

—Right there, standing in front of the closed door, is none other than Mydei himself. A towel is slung over his shoulder, the corner of it brought to his cheek to wipe at the droplets of sweat still clinging to his skin, and Phainon is *totally not staring* as Mydei pulls off the fabric of the jacket that had already been half-off when he had first stepped on stage and replaces it with a simple cotton shirt that covers all but the blue pendant that peeks through nonetheless.

"Are you just going to sit there and stare?" Mydei whispers into his ear, and it is only then that Phainon realises just how close the other had gotten. "Just what do you think you're doing here, *Phainon?* "

Damn you Mydeimos, Phainon gulps as he thinks of a response. Seeing Phainon around the venue's backstage area, especially Mydei's dressing room, was not something unusual and so not one of the staff had stopped him at all, simply waving in greeting. And it seemed that had extended to not saying a word to Mydei himself as well. For good or for bad. Then again, who would question the man who Mydei had so clearly given a copy of his dressing room key to—the lion-shaped pendant clear on Phainon's wrist from where it peeks out from beneath his sleeve.

On second thought, maybe he should have messaged Mydei in advance. What if he didn't have time after all? But it seemed something else clearly hung over the thought, nudging it to the back of his mind until he finally ended up in the situation he was in.

I missed you, Phainon wants to say, but the words remain stuck in his throat, heart beating in his ears as the smell of Mydei's perfume surrounds him, warm and sweet.

"I was just hoping to ask you out for dinner, that's all." The words leave Phainon's mouth before he can think; the alternative perhaps worse than what he was going to say at first. And Phainon blames it on the smell of vanilla drifting through the air, deep and delectable, with a hint of citrus that reminded him of the tarts Mydei had made the other day without even touching an oven.

Mydei looks unimpressed as he lays what had been removed of his costume along the sofa behind Phainon before stepping away, "At this time? Nothing's open, you idiot."

"I could cook—"

"Absolutely not."

Despite Mydei's words, Phainon does indeed cook dinner. An unassuming pan of fried rice coated in egg lovingly made over a fire the best he can, plated and garnished right as the sound of the running shower cuts off and Mydei emerges soon after.

Damp hair is pushed out of his face, chimera-themed hair clips keeping his bangs to the side as he comes up to Phainon, chin resting on his shoulder just as Phainon was about to turn around.

“?” Mydei surely has to be messing with him, the satisfied glint in those golden eyes when Phainon startles at his presence all too telling.

“It looks… passable,” Mydei says when they finally sit at the table, plates between them.

“Just wait till you try it.”

“And if I end up in the hospital?”

“Do you think so lowly of me, Mydeimos…”

The slightest quirk of the corner of a lip, a soft laugh quickly stopped in its tracks, and Mydei is picking up a spoonful of the rice as Phainon watches expectantly, waits for Mydei’s verdict—

Though Phainon gets his answer even before Mydei speaks from the way his eyes widen ever so slightly, looking between the plate of fried rice and Phainon himself who may as well be beaming at him from across the table.

“Well?”

“Perhaps you aren’t so hopeless after all. Thank you for the meal.”

“Hey!”

“I’ll leave my heart with your air, so let me fly with you”

Ten weeks—that’s how long it has been since Phainon had started this whole thing, countless drafts scattered across his apartment and the studio, each one not quite *right* .

Ten days, counting down to his album’s release.

Ten hours, the amount of time Phainon has left to get his work done.

Ten minutes was all Mydei had taken to reach Phainon's apartment following a series of pleading messages sent his way, requesting for him to come over and pull Phainon from his misery. And so he had settled into Phainon's room-turned-makeshift-studio, rarely-seen glasses framing his face and hair pulled into a messy half-bun as he sat cross-legged on Phainon's bed.

And, within ten seconds of looking at Phainon's notes, those golden hands of his had gotten to work. Offering ideas and praise just as much as constructive criticism that held no heat, not that it would have mattered anyway if Mydei had torn it all up insead as Phainon finds himself far too busy being drawn into Mydei's voice as he tests melodies, writes a part of himself into Phainon's story. *And it all clicks together, as if it were always like that.*

But then everything stops, and the next thing Phainon notices is Mydei's beautiful, piercing gaze on him.

"You are distracted," Mydei points out, fingers coming to a stop upon the strings of his guitar as he looks up to face Phainon, who sits up at the words. The pillows around them are a mess, along with the sheets from how he had been shifting before, the paper bin shifted to the foot of the bed filled with crumpled balls of paper. "Spill it, Phainon."

Huh, how do you tell your friend that you kind of fell in love with him? And that hearing him sing the song you wrote while imagining actually being with him was the final piece. It is at times like this that Phainon both loves and hates Mydei's abilities of observation, how he happens to know Phainon so well, almost as if— *No, but it can't be…*

"You wouldn't get it." Phainon says weakly, shoulders drooping.

"Try me." There is a strange fire within Mydei's eyes as he offers, chin propped up on his palm as he watches Phainon expectantly.

And maybe Phainon gives in all too easily, pencil spinning between his fingers as he lets out a breath long and slow. “... Fine.”

As Phainon speaks, talks about the challenge he had given himself, of writing a song encompassing what it is like to fall in love with someone you’re known for a long, *long* , time… of the sweet innocence of the emotion, young and wild as it burns like a flame in the heart, simmers even in quiet moments and filling one’s mind… a strange look crosses Mydei’s face. Somehow, it only has Phainon pressing on where he should probably stop. ‘Foolish’ as he may sound by the end of it all.

How do you write about such a thing without having known it for yourself? Phainon had asked, the question underlined on the first page long since crumpled.

Exhilarating, consuming, like starting a fire— *you are captivated by it, wanting to lean into the warmth of it* —pure and simple, Phainon had called it. And there his answer was, sitting in front of him. Burning bright in a way Phainon was hopelessly enamoured by from the very beginning, dancing around the feeling in a way he was not used to even as his heart offered itself up time and time again.

Long before he even knew it, Phainon had fallen in love. Even if the word itself had not been spoken between them, not yet. Held in the quiet moments carved from their lives, echoing in the music they make together, in the acts that have become a part of their days, hearts intertwined long before…

“I love *you* .” Phainon says, the words quiet yet full of strength. A declaration so intimate, he almost regrets not doing something grander. But perhaps sitting here in a space that had become theirs, clothed so simply that it’s almost like back when they had first met. Nothing but them and their music as far too much honesty is spilled in the space between them.

“You— Do you really not realise what you just…” Mydei mutters, and when Phainon looks up it is to downcast eyes, the shadows of Mydei’s lashes painted across his cheekbone as he suddenly seems to fade into the darkness for a moment before seemingly gathering himself once more. “Phainon.”

“Mydei.”

“... Don’t mess around.”

“I am not.”

Before Phainon can continue, a finger gently seals his lips, Mydei’s touch gentle as he caresses his cheek, and Phainon cannot help the way his breath hitches in his chest as he realises how close they are. Each breath Mydei takes brushes over his lips, so close that Phainon can *feel* the way the other’s heart thunders in his chest even as his face retains its usual composure.

“I am in love with you, Mydeimos.” Phainon repeats again, hand trailing upwards from where it had rested above the other’s heart, following the line of Mydei’s tattoos before burying itself in flame-tipped strands and *finally* closing the distance between them.

The kiss is clumsy, messy, and awkward in all the wrong ways… but Mydei doesn’t seem to mind at all. Not when he falls deeper into it, smiling against Phainon’s lips as he takes over instead, guiding him sweetly, *lovingly* , until Phainon’s lungs burn like the molten heat flowing through his veins.

In the end, there was no need to imagine they had fallen in love. For somehow, somewhere along the way, they truly had.

“Will you be forever with me?”

[Question]: About ‘certain someone’ you mentioned this song was inspired by—here are some burning questions many of your fans have been excited about ever since the announcement: How did you two meet? And might we have any hint as to the identity of this mysterious person?

[Phainon]: *Hah, well that’s a good question…I guess you could say it was love at first sight at a concert. Some friends invited me out, I met his eyes*

across the crowd, maybeee got some help to find him after— and here we are. As for who they are, well~

.. / .-.. --- ...- . / -.-- --- ..-

The words are written on the page of the magazine, previewed upon the screen of the laptop held in front of him, right by the poster image featuring Phainon lying in someone's lap, guitar by the side and the slightest peek of red-tipped hair showing.

"I assume that you have no issues with the content to be published?" Aglaea speaks as she watches Phainon flip through the pages of the preview sent their way, the smile on his face growing wider with each passing second. On one page, Phainon sits with what may as well be a cotton ball of a puppy in his lap—looking much too alike the adorable creature—but with extra troublemaking ability, and Aglaea has to stifle a laugh at the way the expression is almost recreated right in front of her that very moment. *Ah, young love.*

A nod as Phainon sinks back into his seat, watching the buildings pass outside as their car drives down familiar roads, offices giving way to residential buildings. "You know, I thought people would be more surprised…"

" *Phainon,* " Aglaea smiles with a shake of her head as she sends off the email approving the article and closes her laptop, "Fortunately or not, subtlety is not quite one of your strong suits."

"You had a hand in this, didn't you."

"As per the contract, creative direction lies in your hands."

Eventually, the car comes to a stop at the driveway of a library, a familiar figure sitting on a bench just outside of it as a group of children circle around him, flowers in hand as they chatter about.

"Go and meet him."

Phainon does not need to be told twice, already halfway out of the car before he is thanking her. And Aglaea watches as he takes his place by Mydeimos' side, taking a flower offered from one of the kids and placing it in Mydeimos' hair.

.. / .-.. --- ...- . / -.-- --- ..-

[Question]: The last question for today… What is one thing you would like to tell your first love?

[Phainon]: I love you.

♫

"Have I told you how much I love you, Mydei?" Phainon mutters into the top of Mydei's head, arms wrapping tighter around the man as he breathes in the familiar aroma of vanilla, fingers innocently massaging at where reddened marks lie across Mydei's skin. A result of his own greed following their reunion after their schedules finally aligned once more.

A greed Mydei had so readily indulged, even started it himself the moment he had made his way into the car, all sunglasses and cool mystery in the driver's seat before the door had closed.

"Took you long enough." Mydei had said as he pulled Phainon into a kiss, and then another— before pulling away and nudging a small bag in Phainon's direction.

"Mydei~ Are these the cookies you made while we called the other day?"

"No. A fresh batch."

Phainon is just a man in love, and Mydei his sun even in the night, occupying the soft spot in Phainon's heart that had long since been his. So it is with all this love that Phainon had leaned over and pressed their lips together once more, knocking Mydei's sunglasses off in the process (why in

the world was he wearing those at night anyway) and tasting the true sweetness he had been craving.

Now, in the aftermath of their passion, they remain in bed together far later than they usually would have, stretching out each moment as long as they can if only to remain in each other's warmth *just a bit longer* .

Stirring, one golden eye peeks up at him as Mydei tilts his head upward to look at Phainon properly, gold reflecting off the snowy strands of his hair as his sun smiles down at him. "Has something gotten into you?"

"Not at all. Actually, it's me who was just in y—" All it takes is a single pinch to Phainon's side for him to stop, Mydei rolling his eyes at the man who happens to be the one holding his heart.

Shuffling up so he can bring their foreheads together, legs tangling beneath the cover of the blankets, Mydei huffs as he pokes at Phainon's nose. "You are ridiculous. Shameless. Impossible—"

"But you love me."

"Unfortunately, I do."

That wide-eyed look takes its place on Phainon's face, imaginary ears drooping downward as he sends Mydei a look of almost-theatrical pleading that Mydei has fallen far too many times for. "Mydei~ *Mydeimos*~ My—"

This time, a kiss is what silences Phainon; fleetingly left upon those parted lips amidst the whispers of Mydei's name, before Mydei is sits and makes toward the kitchen to prepare breakfast.

"... That's not fair— Mydei, you— Come back here!"

"Unless you would rather be late for our scheduled photoshoot, I suggest you get out of bed now."

"Ah, why did I give you those keys again…"

End Notes

.. / .-.. --- ...- . / -.-- --- ..- (I love you)

♫

Thank you for reading!!! Just another sweet, self-indulgent fic that was *supposed* to be much shorter than it turned out haha.

My first time writing such a sugary little thing in a looong while (I think Phainon accidentally dropped the bag of it in haha) but it was fun and I hope you enjoyed~ Backstage AU has me in its grasp frfr

Feel free to leave any thoughts and all in the comments or say hi on Twitter <3

Works inspired by this one

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